

SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Lok Adalats and Other Courts - Learner-v2 Refreshed

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing



Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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Lok Adalats and Other Courts - Solved Practice Workbook

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

MCQ 1. What is the constitutional anchor for equal access and free legal aid?

- A. Article 39A directs the State to promote justice on equal opportunity and prevent economic or other disability from denying access.
- B. Article 50 establishes Lok Adalats.
- C. Article 136 guarantees free counsel in every dispute.
- D. Article 32 creates every legal-services authority.

Answer: A

Explanation: Article 39A is a Directive Principle operationalised through statutes and Article 21 jurisprudence. The other options confuse the legal source, institution, beneficiary-identification rule, benefit-conferral rule or current-status gate.

MCQ 2. Which institutional description is accurate?

- A. SALSA is the statutory name of every State authority.
- B. NALSA, the Supreme Court Committee, SLSAs, High Court Committees, DLSAs and TLSCs perform level-specific legal-services functions.
- C. DLSAs are constitutional courts.
- D. TLSCs may overrule High Court decisions.

Answer: B

Explanation: The 1987 Act creates a coordinated statutory ladder; SLA is the ordinary abbreviation. The other options confuse the legal source, institution, beneficiary-identification rule, benefit-conferral rule or current-status gate.

MCQ 3. Which statement about free legal-services eligibility is correct?

- A. OBC status by itself is expressly listed in Section 12.
- B. Every senior citizen qualifies solely by age under Section 12.
- C. Eligibility includes several status-based vulnerable categories as well as prescribed income criteria, subject also to a prima facie case assessment.
- D. Only persons below an income ceiling qualify.

Answer: C

Explanation: SC/ST members, women/children, persons in custody and other listed groups do not depend solely on income. The other options confuse the legal source, institution, beneficiary-identification rule, benefit-conferral rule or current-status gate.

MCQ 4. Which matter may an ordinary Lok Adalat handle?

- A. A matter outside all ordinary court jurisdiction.
- B. Only disputes already decided by a High Court.
- C. Every criminal offence regardless of compoundability.
- D. A pending case or pre-litigation dispute within a court's jurisdiction, excluding a non-compoundable offence.

Answer: D

Explanation: Sections 19-20 combine pending and pre-litigation settlement jurisdiction with a criminal-law exclusion. The other options confuse the legal source, institution, beneficiary-identification rule, benefit-conferral rule or current-status gate.

MCQ 5. What may an ordinary Lok Adalat do when settlement fails?

- A. It must not decide the merits; a referred pending case returns to court and parties retain the ordinary remedy.
- B. It may compel one party to accept the proposed terms.
- C. It converts automatically into a Permanent Lok Adalat.
- D. It must impose an equitable merits award.

Answer: A

Explanation: State of Punjab v. Jalour Singh (2008) confirms the compromise-only character. The other options confuse the legal source, institution, beneficiary-identification rule, benefit-conferral rule or current-status gate.

MCQ 6. Which statement about an agreed Lok Adalat award is correct?

- A. The award is only a non-binding recommendation.
- B. It is deemed a civil-court decree, final and binding, and no statutory appeal lies; limited constitutional challenge remains for jurisdictional or consent defects.
- C. Finality validates an award imposed without settlement.
- D. Any dissatisfied party may appeal on facts.

Answer: B

Explanation: Consent supports statutory finality but does not eliminate constitutional review for illegality. The other options confuse the legal source, institution, beneficiary-identification rule, benefit-conferral rule or current-status gate.

MCQ 7. Which feature defines a Permanent Lok Adalat?

- A. It hears every pending civil suit transferred by a court.
- B. It is merely a continuously sitting ordinary Lok Adalat.
- C. It is a standing pre-litigation forum for notified public utility services under Chapter VI-A.
- D. It may try non-compoundable offences.

Answer: C

Explanation: Sector, stage and statutory exclusions define PLA competence. The other options confuse the legal source, institution, beneficiary-identification rule, benefit-conferral rule or current-status gate.

MCQ 8. When may a PLA decide an eligible dispute on merits?

- A. Never; all Lok Adalats are compromise-only.
- B. Only with a fresh arbitral agreement.
- C. Before attempting conciliation.
- D. After conducting the statutory conciliation process and failing to secure settlement, subject to jurisdictional limits.

Answer: D

Explanation: Bar Council of India (2012) and Canara Bank v. G.S. Jayarama (2022) support the conciliation-cum-adjudication design. The other options confuse the legal source, institution, beneficiary-identification rule, benefit-conferral rule or current-status gate.

MCQ 9. Which statement about a Gram Nyayalaya is correct?

- A. It is a statutory mobile-capable court of first instance with scheduled civil/criminal jurisdiction and appellate routes.
- B. Its awards are unappealable compromises.
- C. It is constitutionally mandatory in every Panchayat.
- D. It is a village panchayat exercising customary power.

Answer: A

Explanation: The 2008 Act creates a judicial forum; establishment and operation remain State-dependent. The other options confuse the legal source, institution, beneficiary-identification rule, benefit-conferral rule or current-status gate.

MCQ 10. Which feature distinguishes a Family Court?

- A. It can only record compromises.
- B. It combines specialised statutory adjudication with a duty to explore settlement, privacy tools and a defined High Court appeal.
- C. Lawyers have an unconditional right of appearance as of course.
- D. It is an arbitral tribunal chosen by contract.

Answer: B

Explanation: Conciliation orientation does not remove adjudicatory power or fairness duties. The other options confuse the legal source, institution, beneficiary-identification rule, benefit-conferral rule or current-status gate.

MCQ 11. Which classification is accurate?

- A. Every special court is a tribunal outside the judiciary.
- B. Both are new constitutional tiers.
- C. Fast-track courts are capacity/administrative schemes, while special courts obtain jurisdiction from a parent statute or valid notification.
- D. An evening court has nationwide statutory jurisdiction.

Answer: C

Explanation: Labels do not answer source, appointment, procedure or appeal. The other options confuse the legal source, institution, beneficiary-identification rule, benefit-conferral rule or current-status gate.

MCQ 12. Which comparison is legally correct?

- A. All four can decide non-compoundable criminal offences.
- B. Every outcome has the same appeal and enforcement route.
- C. All four require an identical prior contract.
- D. Mediation produces a party-made settlement, arbitration produces an adjudicatory award, ordinary Lok Adalat records compromise, and a PLA has limited post-conciliation merits power.

Answer: D

Explanation: Consent, jurisdiction, decision-maker and legal effect differ across dispute-resolution designs. The other options confuse the legal source, institution, beneficiary-identification rule, benefit-conferral rule or current-status gate.

MCQ 13. Which close-option distinction is constitutionally accurate concerning Article 39A?

- A. Article 39A directs the State to promote justice on equal opportunity and prevent economic or other disability from denying access.
- B. Article 32 creates every legal-services authority.
- C. Article 136 guarantees free counsel in every dispute.
- D. Article 50 establishes Lok Adalats.

Answer: A

Explanation: Article 39A is a Directive Principle operationalised through statutes and Article 21 jurisprudence. The other options confuse the legal source, institution, beneficiary-identification rule, benefit-conferral rule or current-status gate.

MCQ 14. Which close-option distinction is constitutionally accurate concerning the legal-services ladder?

- A. DLSAs are constitutional courts.
- B. NALSA, the Supreme Court Committee, SLSAs, High Court Committees, DLSAs and TLSCs perform level-specific legal-services functions.
- C. SALSA is the statutory name of every State authority.
- D. TLSCs may overrule High Court decisions.

Answer: B

Explanation: The 1987 Act creates a coordinated statutory ladder; SLSA is the ordinary abbreviation. The other options confuse the legal source, institution, beneficiary-identification rule, benefit-conferral rule or current-status gate.

MCQ 15. Which close-option distinction is constitutionally accurate concerning Section 12 eligibility?

- A. OBC status by itself is expressly listed in Section 12.
- B. Every senior citizen qualifies solely by age under Section 12.
- C. Eligibility includes several status-based vulnerable categories as well as prescribed income criteria, subject also to a prima facie case assessment.
- D. Only persons below an income ceiling qualify.

Answer: C

Explanation: SC/ST members, women/children, persons in custody and other listed groups do not depend solely on income. The other options confuse the legal source, institution, beneficiary-identification rule, benefit-conferral rule or current-status gate.

MCQ 16. Which close-option distinction is constitutionally accurate concerning ordinary Lok Adalat jurisdiction?

- A. Every criminal offence regardless of compoundability.
- B. Only disputes already decided by a High Court.
- C. A matter outside all ordinary court jurisdiction.
- D. A pending case or pre-litigation dispute within a court's jurisdiction, excluding a non-compoundable offence.

Answer: D

Explanation: Sections 19-20 combine pending and pre-litigation settlement jurisdiction with a criminal-law exclusion. The other options confuse the legal source, institution, beneficiary-identification rule, benefit-conferral rule or current-status gate.

MCQ 17. Which close-option distinction is constitutionally accurate concerning ordinary Lok Adalat power?

- A. It must not decide the merits; a referred pending case returns to court and parties retain the ordinary remedy.
- B. It must impose an equitable merits award.
- C. It converts automatically into a Permanent Lok Adalat.
- D. It may compel one party to accept the proposed terms.

Answer: A

Explanation: State of Punjab v. Jalour Singh (2008) confirms the compromise-only character. The other options confuse the legal source, institution, beneficiary-identification rule, benefit-conferral rule or current-status gate.

MCQ 18. Which close-option distinction is constitutionally accurate concerning ordinary Lok Adalat awards?

- A. Any dissatisfied party may appeal on facts.
- B. It is deemed a civil-court decree, final and binding, and no statutory appeal lies; limited constitutional challenge remains for jurisdictional or consent defects.
- C. Finality validates an award imposed without settlement.
- D. The award is only a non-binding recommendation.

Answer: B

Explanation: Consent supports statutory finality but does not eliminate constitutional review for illegality. The other options confuse the legal source, institution, beneficiary-identification rule, benefit-conferral rule or current-status gate.

MCQ 19. Which close-option distinction is constitutionally accurate concerning Permanent Lok Adalat jurisdiction?

- A. It hears every pending civil suit transferred by a court.
- B. It is merely a continuously sitting ordinary Lok Adalat.
- C. It is a standing pre-litigation forum for notified public utility services under Chapter VI-A.
- D. It may try non-compoundable offences.

Answer: C

Explanation: Sector, stage and statutory exclusions define PLA competence. The other options confuse the legal source, institution, beneficiary-identification rule, benefit-conferral rule or current-status gate.

MCQ 20. Which close-option distinction is constitutionally accurate concerning Permanent Lok Adalat merits power?

- A. Never; all Lok Adalats are compromise-only.
- B. Before attempting conciliation.
- C. Only with a fresh arbitral agreement.
- D. After conducting the statutory conciliation process and failing to secure settlement, subject to jurisdictional limits.

Answer: D

Explanation: Bar Council of India (2012) and Canara Bank v. G.S. Jayarama (2022) support the conciliation-cum-adjudication design. The other options confuse the legal source, institution, beneficiary-identification rule, benefit-conferral rule or current-status gate.

MCQ 21. Which close-option distinction is constitutionally accurate concerning Gram Nyayalayas?

- A. It is a statutory mobile-capable court of first instance with scheduled civil/criminal jurisdiction and appellate routes.
- B. It is a village panchayat exercising customary power.
- C. It is constitutionally mandatory in every Panchayat.
- D. Its awards are unappealable compromises.

Answer: A

Explanation: The 2008 Act creates a judicial forum; establishment and operation remain State-dependent. The other options confuse the legal source, institution, beneficiary-identification rule, benefit-conferral rule or current-status gate.

MCQ 22. Which close-option distinction is constitutionally accurate concerning Family Courts?

- A. It is an arbitral tribunal chosen by contract.
- B. It combines specialised statutory adjudication with a duty to explore settlement, privacy tools and a defined High Court appeal.
- C. It can only record compromises.
- D. Lawyers have an unconditional right of appearance as of course.

Answer: B

Explanation: Conciliation orientation does not remove adjudicatory power or fairness duties. The other options confuse the legal source, institution, beneficiary-identification rule, benefit-conferral rule or current-status gate.

MCQ 23. Which close-option distinction is constitutionally accurate concerning fast-track and special courts?

- A. An evening court has nationwide statutory jurisdiction.
- B. Both are new constitutional tiers.
- C. Fast-track courts are capacity/administrative schemes, while special courts obtain jurisdiction from a parent statute or valid notification.
- D. Every special court is a tribunal outside the judiciary.

Answer: C

Explanation: Labels do not answer source, appointment, procedure or appeal. The other options confuse the legal source, institution, beneficiary-identification rule, benefit-conferral rule or current-status gate.

MCQ 24. Which close-option distinction is constitutionally accurate concerning mediation, arbitration and Lok Adalat?

- A. All four can decide non-compoundable criminal offences.
- B. All four require an identical prior contract.
- C. Every outcome has the same appeal and enforcement route.
- D. Mediation produces a party-made settlement, arbitration produces an adjudicatory award, ordinary Lok Adalat records compromise, and a PLA has limited post-conciliation merits power.

Answer: D

Explanation: Consent, jurisdiction, decision-maker and legal effect differ across dispute-resolution designs. The other options confuse the legal source, institution, beneficiary-identification rule, benefit-conferral rule or current-status gate.

MCQ 25. A State authority adopts the following proposition. Which correction is legally safest?

- A. Article 39A directs the State to promote justice on equal opportunity and prevent economic or other disability from denying access.
- B. Article 50 establishes Lok Adalats.
- C. Article 136 guarantees free counsel in every dispute.
- D. The proposition is valid because all affirmative-action powers are interchangeable.

Answer: A

Explanation: Article 39A is a Directive Principle operationalised through statutes and Article 21 jurisprudence. The other options confuse the legal source, institution, beneficiary-identification rule, benefit-conferral rule or current-status gate.

MCQ 26. A State authority adopts the following proposition. Which correction is legally safest?

- A. DLSAs are constitutional courts.
- B. NALSA, the Supreme Court Committee, SLSAs, High Court Committees, DLSAs and TLSCs perform level-specific legal-services functions.
- C. TLSCs may overrule High Court decisions.
- D. The proposition is valid because all affirmative-action powers are interchangeable.

Answer: B

Explanation: The 1987 Act creates a coordinated statutory ladder; SLSC is the ordinary abbreviation. The other options confuse the legal source, institution, beneficiary-identification rule, benefit-conferral rule or current-status gate.

MCQ 27. A State authority adopts the following proposition. Which correction is legally safest?

- A. The proposition is valid because all affirmative-action powers are interchangeable.
- B. OBC status by itself is expressly listed in Section 12.
- C. Eligibility includes several status-based vulnerable categories as well as prescribed income criteria, subject also to a prima facie case assessment.
- D. Every senior citizen qualifies solely by age under Section 12.

Answer: C

Explanation: SC/ST members, women/children, persons in custody and other listed groups do not depend solely on income. The other options confuse the legal source, institution, beneficiary-identification rule, benefit-conferral rule or current-status gate.

MCQ 28. A State authority adopts the following proposition. Which correction is legally safest?

- A. A matter outside all ordinary court jurisdiction.
- B. The proposition is valid because all affirmative-action powers are interchangeable.
- C. Every criminal offence regardless of compoundability.
- D. A pending case or pre-litigation dispute within a court's jurisdiction, excluding a non-compoundable offence.

Answer: D

Explanation: Sections 19-20 combine pending and pre-litigation settlement jurisdiction with a criminal-law exclusion. The other options confuse the legal source, institution, beneficiary-identification rule, benefit-conferral rule or current-status gate.

MCQ 29. A State authority adopts the following proposition. Which correction is legally safest?

- A. It must not decide the merits; a referred pending case returns to court and parties retain the ordinary remedy.
- B. It converts automatically into a Permanent Lok Adalat.
- C. The proposition is valid because all affirmative-action powers are interchangeable.
- D. It may compel one party to accept the proposed terms.

Answer: A

Explanation: State of Punjab v. Jalour Singh (2008) confirms the compromise-only character. The other options confuse the legal source, institution, beneficiary-identification rule, benefit-conferral rule or current-status gate.

MCQ 30. A State authority adopts the following proposition. Which correction is legally safest?

- A. The proposition is valid because all affirmative-action powers are interchangeable.
- B. It is deemed a civil-court decree, final and binding, and no statutory appeal lies; limited constitutional challenge remains for jurisdictional or consent defects.
- C. Finality validates an award imposed without settlement.
- D. The award is only a non-binding recommendation.

Answer: B

Explanation: Consent supports statutory finality but does not eliminate constitutional review for illegality. The other options confuse the legal source, institution, beneficiary-identification rule, benefit-conferral rule or current-status gate.

MCQ 31. A State authority adopts the following proposition. Which correction is legally safest?

- A. It may try non-compoundable offences.
- B. The proposition is valid because all affirmative-action powers are interchangeable.
- C. It is a standing pre-litigation forum for notified public utility services under Chapter VI-A.
- D. It is merely a continuously sitting ordinary Lok Adalat.

Answer: C

Explanation: Sector, stage and statutory exclusions define PLA competence. The other options confuse the legal source, institution, beneficiary-identification rule, benefit-conferral rule or current-status gate.

MCQ 32. A State authority adopts the following proposition. Which correction is legally safest?

- A. Only with a fresh arbitral agreement.
- B. Never; all Lok Adalats are compromise-only.
- C. The proposition is valid because all affirmative-action powers are interchangeable.
- D. After conducting the statutory conciliation process and failing to secure settlement, subject to jurisdictional limits.

Answer: D

Explanation: Bar Council of India (2012) and Canara Bank v. G.S. Jayarama (2022) support the conciliation-cum-adjudication design. The other options confuse the legal source, institution, beneficiary-identification rule, benefit-conferral rule or current-status gate.

MCQ 33. A State authority adopts the following proposition. Which correction is legally safest?

- A. It is a statutory mobile-capable court of first instance with scheduled civil/criminal jurisdiction and appellate routes.
- B. Its awards are unappealable compromises.
- C. It is constitutionally mandatory in every Panchayat.
- D. The proposition is valid because all affirmative-action powers are interchangeable.

Answer: A

Explanation: The 2008 Act creates a judicial forum; establishment and operation remain State-dependent. The other options confuse the legal source, institution, beneficiary-identification rule, benefit-conferral rule or current-status gate.

MCQ 34. A State authority adopts the following proposition. Which correction is legally safest?

- A. The proposition is valid because all affirmative-action powers are interchangeable.
- B. It combines specialised statutory adjudication with a duty to explore settlement, privacy tools and a defined High Court appeal.
- C. Lawyers have an unconditional right of appearance as of course.
- D. It is an arbitral tribunal chosen by contract.

Answer: B

Explanation: Conciliation orientation does not remove adjudicatory power or fairness duties. The other options confuse the legal source, institution, beneficiary-identification rule, benefit-conferral rule or current-status gate.

MCQ 35. A State authority adopts the following proposition. Which correction is legally safest?

- A. An evening court has nationwide statutory jurisdiction.
- B. Every special court is a tribunal outside the judiciary.
- C. Fast-track courts are capacity/administrative schemes, while special courts obtain jurisdiction from a parent statute or valid notification.
- D. The proposition is valid because all affirmative-action powers are interchangeable.

Answer: C

Explanation: Labels do not answer source, appointment, procedure or appeal. The other options confuse the legal source, institution, beneficiary-identification rule, benefit-conferral rule or current-status gate.

MCQ 36. A State authority adopts the following proposition. Which correction is legally safest?

- A. The proposition is valid because all affirmative-action powers are interchangeable.
- B. All four require an identical prior contract.
- C. Every outcome has the same appeal and enforcement route.
- D. Mediation produces a party-made settlement, arbitration produces an adjudicatory award, ordinary Lok Adalat records compromise, and a PLA has limited post-conciliation merits power.

Answer: D

Explanation: Consent, jurisdiction, decision-maker and legal effect differ across dispute-resolution designs. The other options confuse the legal source, institution, beneficiary-identification rule, benefit-conferral rule or current-status gate.

MCQ 37. For a UPSC answer on Article 39A, which proposition should anchor the analysis?

- A. Article 39A directs the State to promote justice on equal opportunity and prevent economic or other disability from denying access.
- B. Article 32 creates every legal-services authority.
- C. The issue is controlled only by executive policy and not constitutional text.
- D. Article 50 establishes Lok Adalats.

Answer: A

Explanation: Article 39A is a Directive Principle operationalised through statutes and Article 21 jurisprudence. The other options confuse the legal source, institution, beneficiary-identification rule, benefit-conferral rule or current-status gate.

MCQ 38. For a UPSC answer on the legal-services ladder, which proposition should anchor the analysis?

- A. The issue is controlled only by executive policy and not constitutional text.
- B. NALSA, the Supreme Court Committee, SLSAs, High Court Committees, DLSAs and TLSCs perform level-specific legal-services functions.
- C. TLSCs may overrule High Court decisions.
- D. SALSA is the statutory name of every State authority.

Answer: B

Explanation: The 1987 Act creates a coordinated statutory ladder; SLISA is the ordinary abbreviation. The other options confuse the legal source, institution, beneficiary-identification rule, benefit-conferral rule or current-status gate.

MCQ 39. For a UPSC answer on Section 12 eligibility, which proposition should anchor the analysis?

- A. OBC status by itself is expressly listed in Section 12.
- B. Only persons below an income ceiling qualify.
- C. Eligibility includes several status-based vulnerable categories as well as prescribed income criteria, subject also to a prima facie case assessment.
- D. The issue is controlled only by executive policy and not constitutional text.

Answer: C

Explanation: SC/ST members, women/children, persons in custody and other listed groups do not depend solely on income. The other options confuse the legal source, institution, beneficiary-identification rule, benefit-conferral rule or current-status gate.

MCQ 40. For a UPSC answer on ordinary Lok Adalat jurisdiction, which proposition should anchor the analysis?

- A. Only disputes already decided by a High Court.
- B. The issue is controlled only by executive policy and not constitutional text.
- C. A matter outside all ordinary court jurisdiction.
- D. A pending case or pre-litigation dispute within a court's jurisdiction, excluding a non-compoundable offence.

Answer: D

Explanation: Sections 19-20 combine pending and pre-litigation settlement jurisdiction with a criminal-law exclusion. The other options confuse the legal source, institution, beneficiary-identification rule, benefit-conferral rule or current-status gate.

MCQ 41. For a UPSC answer on ordinary Lok Adalat power, which proposition should anchor the analysis?

- A. It must not decide the merits; a referred pending case returns to court and parties retain the ordinary remedy.
- B. It must impose an equitable merits award.
- C. It may compel one party to accept the proposed terms.
- D. The issue is controlled only by executive policy and not constitutional text.

Answer: A

Explanation: State of Punjab v. Jalour Singh (2008) confirms the compromise-only character. The other options confuse the legal source, institution, beneficiary-identification rule, benefit-conferral rule or current-status gate.

MCQ 42. For a UPSC answer on ordinary Lok Adalat awards, which proposition should anchor the analysis?

- A. Any dissatisfied party may appeal on facts.
- B. It is deemed a civil-court decree, final and binding, and no statutory appeal lies; limited constitutional challenge remains for jurisdictional or consent defects.
- C. The issue is controlled only by executive policy and not constitutional text.
- D. Finality validates an award imposed without settlement.

Answer: B

Explanation: Consent supports statutory finality but does not eliminate constitutional review for illegality. The other options confuse the legal source, institution, beneficiary-identification rule, benefit-conferral rule or current-status gate.

MCQ 43. For a UPSC answer on Permanent Lok Adalat jurisdiction, which proposition should anchor the analysis?

- A. It may try non-compoundable offences.
- B. It hears every pending civil suit transferred by a court.
- C. It is a standing pre-litigation forum for notified public utility services under Chapter VI-A.
- D. The issue is controlled only by executive policy and not constitutional text.

Answer: C

Explanation: Sector, stage and statutory exclusions define PLA competence. The other options confuse the legal source, institution, beneficiary-identification rule, benefit-conferral rule or current-status gate.

MCQ 44. For a UPSC answer on Permanent Lok Adalat merits power, which proposition should anchor the analysis?

- A. Before attempting conciliation.
- B. The issue is controlled only by executive policy and not constitutional text.
- C. Never; all Lok Adalats are compromise-only.
- D. After conducting the statutory conciliation process and failing to secure settlement, subject to jurisdictional limits.

Answer: D

Explanation: Bar Council of India (2012) and Canara Bank v. G.S. Jayarama (2022) support the conciliation-cum-adjudication design. The other options confuse the legal source, institution, beneficiary-identification rule, benefit-conferral rule or current-status gate.

MCQ 45. For a UPSC answer on Gram Nyayalayas, which proposition should anchor the analysis?

- A. It is a statutory mobile-capable court of first instance with scheduled civil/criminal jurisdiction and appellate routes.
- B. It is a village panchayat exercising customary power.
- C. It is constitutionally mandatory in every Panchayat.
- D. The issue is controlled only by executive policy and not constitutional text.

Answer: A

Explanation: The 2008 Act creates a judicial forum; establishment and operation remain State-dependent. The other options confuse the legal source, institution, beneficiary-identification rule, benefit-conferral rule or current-status gate.

MCQ 46. For a UPSC answer on Family Courts, which proposition should anchor the analysis?

- A. Lawyers have an unconditional right of appearance as of course.
- B. It combines specialised statutory adjudication with a duty to explore settlement, privacy tools and a defined High Court appeal.
- C. The issue is controlled only by executive policy and not constitutional text.
- D. It can only record compromises.

Answer: B

Explanation: Conciliation orientation does not remove adjudicatory power or fairness duties. The other options confuse the legal source, institution, beneficiary-identification rule, benefit-conferral rule or current-status gate.

MCQ 47. For a UPSC answer on fast-track and special courts, which proposition should anchor the analysis?

- A. An evening court has nationwide statutory jurisdiction.
- B. The issue is controlled only by executive policy and not constitutional text.
- C. Fast-track courts are capacity/administrative schemes, while special courts obtain jurisdiction from a parent statute or valid notification.
- D. Both are new constitutional tiers.

Answer: C

Explanation: Labels do not answer source, appointment, procedure or appeal. The other options confuse the legal source, institution, beneficiary-identification rule, benefit-conferral rule or current-status gate.

MCQ 48. For a UPSC answer on mediation, arbitration and Lok Adalat, which proposition should anchor the analysis?

- A. All four can decide non-compoundable criminal offences.
- B. The issue is controlled only by executive policy and not constitutional text.
- C. Every outcome has the same appeal and enforcement route.
- D. Mediation produces a party-made settlement, arbitration produces an adjudicatory award, ordinary Lok Adalat records compromise, and a PLA has limited post-conciliation merits power.

Answer: D

Explanation: Consent, jurisdiction, decision-maker and legal effect differ across dispute-resolution designs. The other options confuse the legal source, institution, beneficiary-identification rule, benefit-conferral rule or current-status gate.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

Verified PYQ 1 - UPSC Prelims 2020, GS Paper I, Question 9

Exact question: In India, Legal Services Authorities provide free legal services to which of the following type of citizens?

1. Person with an annual income of less than Rs. 1,00,000
 2. Transgender with an annual income of less than Rs. 2,00,000
 3. Member of Other Backward Classes (OBC) with an annual income of less than Rs. 3,00,000
 4. All Senior Citizens
- A. 1 and 2 only
 - B. 3 and 4 only
 - C. 2 and 3 only
 - D. 1 and 4 only

Verified answer: A, reconciled with the applicable legal-services eligibility framework; no official UPSC key is claimed from the repository.

Verified PYQ 2 - UPSC Mains 2023, GS Paper II, Question 2

Exact question: "Who are entitled to receive free legal aid? Assess the role of the National Legal Services Authority (NALSA) in rendering free legal aid in India." **10 marks, 150 words.**

Model answer: Article 39A directs equal access to justice and the Legal Services Authorities Act 1987 converts that objective into institutions and entitlements. Section 12 covers SC/ST members, women and children, trafficking/beggar victims, persons with disability, disaster or violence victims, industrial workmen, persons in custody and persons below the prescribed income limit, subject to a prima facie case. NALSA lays down policy, frames economical schemes, coordinates State Authorities, supports Lok Adalats and legal-awareness programmes, and monitors delivery through the statutory ladder. Its strength is national coordination; its limits are uneven awareness, counsel quality, vacancies, distance and digital exclusion. NALSA should therefore be assessed not only by beneficiary counts but by timely advice, representation quality and durable case outcomes.

Why this earns marks: It answers both entitlement and institutional role. **How to improve:** Name Section 12 and distinguish NALSA from SLA/DLSA implementation. **Compression:** 30 words on law, 85 on role and 30 on limits/verdict.

Verified PYQ 3 - UPSC Mains 2024, GS Paper II, Question 2

Exact printed wording: "Explain and distinguish between Lok Adalats and Arbitration Tribunals, Whether they entertain civil as well as criminal cases?" **10 marks, 150 words.**

Model answer: Lok Adalats are statutory settlement forums under the Legal Services Authorities Act. An ordinary Lok Adalat may consider pending or pre-litigation civil disputes and compoundable criminal matters, but cannot adjudicate merits when compromise fails. Its agreed award is deemed a civil-court decree, final and non-appealable. An arbitral tribunal derives jurisdiction from an arbitration agreement and the Arbitration and Conciliation Act; it adjudicates arbitrable civil or commercial disputes and issues a reasoned award subject to the statutory setting-aside and appeal framework. Criminal liability is generally non-arbitrable, whereas a Lok Adalat can settle a compoundable criminal case. A Permanent Lok Adalat is a separate public-utility pre-litigation hybrid and should not be used to describe every Lok Adalat.

Why this earns marks: It distinguishes source, consent, jurisdiction, merits power and review. **How to improve:** Preserve the paper's printed spellings only in the quotation, then use correct legal terminology. **Compression:** two 50-word forum capsules and a 30-word criminal-case verdict.

Original solved Mains practice

M1. Explain the constitutional and statutory architecture of free legal services in India.

Directive: Explain | **Marks:** 10 | **Answer in:** 150 words.

Demand decode: Define the exact constitutional issue, organise by legal source and effect, use named evidence, confront the strongest limit and reach a qualified verdict.

Model answer: Article 39A supplies the equal-access objective, while Article 21 jurisprudence treats effective legal assistance and speedy justice as elements of fair procedure. The Legal Services Authorities Act 1987 creates NALSA, the Supreme Court Legal Services Committee, SLSAs, High Court Committees, DLSAs and TLSCs. Section 12 combines status-based vulnerability with income eligibility and a prima facie case screen. NALSA frames policy and schemes; State and district institutions translate them into representation, advice, awareness and Lok Adalat access. The architecture is therefore vertically coordinated but delivery-dependent. Its constitutional success must be measured by early advice, competent counsel, language/disability access and actual outcomes rather than formal eligibility alone.

Why this earns marks: The answer follows claim -> named Article/amendment/case -> analysis -> qualification and directly obeys the directive.

How to improve: Convert the first sentence into a precise thesis, underline the controlling Articles/cases and reserve the final two sentences for a graded conclusion.

Compression plan: 20-25 words of introduction, 85 words of organised analysis and 25-35 words of qualified conclusion.

M2. Distinguish ordinary Lok Adalats from Permanent Lok Adalats.

Directive: Distinguish | **Marks:** 15 | **Answer in:** 250 words.

Demand decode: Define the exact constitutional issue, organise by legal source and effect, use named evidence, confront the strongest limit and reach a qualified verdict.

Model answer: An ordinary Lok Adalat under Chapter VI handles pending or pre-litigation disputes within court jurisdiction, excluding non-compoundable offences. It conciliates only; State of Punjab v. Jalour Singh (2008) confirms that it cannot decide merits after failure. A PLA under Chapter VI-A is a standing pre-litigation forum limited to public utility services. It must first conciliate, but may adjudicate an eligible dispute after conciliation fails, as sustained in Bar Council of India v. Union of India (2012). Both awards are final, binding and deemed civil-court decrees, yet their jurisdictional basis differs. The core distinction is not permanence alone but sector, stage and post-failure decisional power.

Why this earns marks: The answer follows claim -> named Article/amendment/case -> analysis -> qualification and directly obeys the directive.

How to improve: Convert the first sentence into a precise thesis, underline the controlling Articles/cases and reserve the final two sentences for a graded conclusion.

Compression plan: 20-25 words of introduction, 175 words of organised analysis and 25-35 words of qualified conclusion.

M3. Critically assess finality and consent in Lok Adalat awards.

Directive: Critically assess | **Marks:** 15 | **Answer in:** 250 words.

Demand decode: Define the exact constitutional issue, organise by legal source and effect, use named evidence, confront the strongest limit and reach a qualified verdict.

Model answer: Statutory finality makes an agreed Lok Adalat award enforceable as a civil-court decree and prevents routine appeals, reducing delay and preserving settlements. Its legitimacy, however, derives from genuine compromise. An ordinary Lok Adalat cannot use docket pressure, unequal bargaining or an adjudicatory opinion to manufacture consent. Where compromise fails, a pending case returns to court. A writ challenge may remain on narrow grounds such as fraud, absence of consent, jurisdictional error or denial of natural justice. PLA awards involve a different statutory design because eligible disputes may be decided after failed conciliation. Finality should therefore be defended as settlement enforcement, not as insulation of coercion or illegality.

Why this earns marks: The answer follows claim -> named Article/amendment/case -> analysis -> qualification and directly obeys the directive.

How to improve: Convert the first sentence into a precise thesis, underline the controlling Articles/cases and reserve the final two sentences for a graded conclusion.

Compression plan: 20-25 words of introduction, 175 words of organised analysis and 25-35 words of qualified conclusion.

M4. Evaluate Permanent Lok Adalats as public-utility justice institutions.

Directive: Evaluate | **Marks:** 20 | **Answer in:** 250 words.

Demand decode: Define the exact constitutional issue, organise by legal source and effect, use named evidence, confront the strongest limit and reach a qualified verdict.

Model answer: Permanent Lok Adalats address recurring pre-litigation disputes in notified public utility services such as transport, power, water, sanitation, hospitals and insurance. Their sequence-application, conciliation, proposed settlement and, on failure, limited merits adjudication-offers an enforceable remedy without requiring ordinary litigation. *Canara Bank v. G.S. Jayarama* (2022) stresses fidelity to the conciliation procedure. Benefits include low cost, sector focus and early resolution; risks include jurisdictional overreach, weak legal assistance and confusing PLA adjudication with ordinary Lok Adalat compromise. Pecuniary limits and notified services are date-sensitive and must be verified. PLAs are valuable when competence, procedural fairness, reasoned decision and constitutional review operate together.

Why this earns marks: The answer follows claim -> named Article/amendment/case -> analysis -> qualification and directly obeys the directive.

How to improve: Convert the first sentence into a precise thesis, underline the controlling Articles/cases and reserve the final two sentences for a graded conclusion.

Compression plan: 20-25 words of introduction, 175 words of organised analysis and 25-35 words of qualified conclusion.

M5. Discuss the design and implementation challenges of Gram Nyayalayas.

Directive: Discuss | **Marks:** 15 | **Answer in:** 250 words.

Demand decode: Define the exact constitutional issue, organise by legal source and effect, use named evidence, confront the strongest limit and reach a qualified verdict.

Model answer: The Gram Nyayalayas Act 2008 envisages rural first-instance courts at intermediate-Panchayat or grouped-Panchayat level, a Nyayadhikari qualified as a Judicial Magistrate First Class, mobile sittings, scheduled civil/criminal jurisdiction, conciliation and appeals to District or Sessions Courts. This design reduces distance and procedural cost while preserving judicial character. Yet establishment is State-dependent and proximity without

judges, staff, awareness, transport, language support and coordination with police/legal aid cannot deliver access. Gram Nyayalayas must not be confused with Panchayats or Lok Adalats. Reform requires rational jurisdiction mapping, regular mobile calendars, DLSA integration and transparent dated performance data.

Why this earns marks: The answer follows claim -> named Article/amendment/case -> analysis -> qualification and directly obeys the directive.

How to improve: Convert the first sentence into a precise thesis, underline the controlling Articles/cases and reserve the final two sentences for a graded conclusion.

Compression plan: 20-25 words of introduction, 175 words of organised analysis and 25-35 words of qualified conclusion.

M6. Compare Family Courts, fast-track courts, special courts and commercial courts.

Directive: Compare | **Marks:** 15 | **Answer in:** 250 words.

Demand decode: Define the exact constitutional issue, organise by legal source and effect, use named evidence, confront the strongest limit and reach a qualified verdict.

Model answer: Family Courts derive from the 1984 Act and combine specialised adjudication with settlement, privacy and flexible evidentiary reception. Fast-track courts are additional-capacity schemes implemented through States and High Courts rather than a distinct constitutional tier. Special courts obtain subject or offence jurisdiction from a parent statute/notification. Commercial Courts are statutory civil courts using specified-value jurisdiction, case management and pre-institution mediation rules. Therefore the labels cannot be interchanged: source determines judges, jurisdiction, procedure, appeal and permanence. Specialisation can improve expertise and speed, but only adequate staffing and fair process prevent a faster forum from becoming a weaker one.

Why this earns marks: The answer follows claim -> named Article/amendment/case -> analysis -> qualification and directly obeys the directive.

How to improve: Convert the first sentence into a precise thesis, underline the controlling Articles/cases and reserve the final two sentences for a graded conclusion.

Compression plan: 20-25 words of introduction, 175 words of organised analysis and 25-35 words of qualified conclusion.

M7. Analyse power asymmetry and digital exclusion in settlement-oriented justice.

Directive: Analyse | **Marks:** 20 | **Answer in:** 250 words.

Demand decode: Define the exact constitutional issue, organise by legal source and effect, use named evidence, confront the strongest limit and reach a qualified verdict.

Model answer: Settlement systems lower cost and preserve relationships, but apparent consent may conceal unequal bargaining between insurer and victim, employer and worker, institution and consumer, or digitally connected and excluded parties. Fair design requires independent legal advice, understandable terms, interpreter and disability support, private communication, time to reflect and a clear record of consent. E-Lok Adalats and online mediation reduce travel but need identity assurance, secure documents, language access and an offline alternative. Disposal volume cannot be the sole metric. Durable compliance, informed consent and equitable outcomes better express Article 39A.

Why this earns marks: The answer follows claim -> named Article/amendment/case -> analysis -> qualification and directly obeys the directive.

How to improve: Convert the first sentence into a precise thesis, underline the controlling Articles/cases and reserve the final two sentences for a graded conclusion.

Compression plan: 20-25 words of introduction, 175 words of organised analysis and 25-35 words of qualified conclusion.

M8. Design a forum-selection test for an access-to-justice problem.

Directive: Design | **Marks:** 10 | **Answer in:** 150 words.

Demand decode: Define the exact constitutional issue, organise by legal source and effect, use named evidence, confront the strongest limit and reach a qualified verdict.

Model answer: Ask five questions. First, is coercive interim relief or authoritative precedent required? If yes, use a competent court. Second, is settlement voluntary and relationship-preserving? Consider mediation or ordinary Lok Adalat. Third, is it a pre-litigation public-utility dispute within PLA limits? Use the PLA sequence. Fourth, is local first-instance civil/criminal jurisdiction under the Gram Nyayalayas Act available? Fifth, is specialist statutory jurisdiction-family, commercial or offence-specific-triggered? Then verify appeal, legal aid, limitation, current notification and digital/offline access. Forum follows legal competence and fairness, not disposal targets.

Why this earns marks: The answer follows claim -> named Article/amendment/case -> analysis -> qualification and directly obeys the directive.

How to improve: Convert the first sentence into a precise thesis, underline the controlling Articles/cases and reserve the final two sentences for a graded conclusion.

Compression plan: 20-25 words of introduction, 85 words of organised analysis and 25-35 words of qualified conclusion.